



THE ICONOCLAST

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An Iconoclast Manifesto by Anthony Simeone

Variety is not just the spice of life alone. What of the things that spring from life, human life in particular? Take art, for example. There are different opinions concerning what purpose art fulfills in a culture. Some say it can be used to solidify tradition, or just as easily tear it out by the roots. Of course, the opinions of what art is at all are highly variable. It would behoove me at this point in this missive to forewarn the intrepid reader. This humble scribe believes that all endeavors we mortals undertake are subjective, open to interpretation and opinion, biased, etc. Indeed reality itself (oh looky, another human creation that we forgot we made!) as a concept is really only so much abstract taffy, currently being pulled in approximately 6 billion ways (this number being the current estimated population of the Earth). I guess what I am trying to write is that I feel that there is no such thing as an objective...anything!

But all tangents and disclaimers aside...art, in all of its myriad forms, has numerous purposes. It is supposed to sometimes shock, sometimes enlighten, sometimes give joy and hope, sometimes depress, sometimes teach, and always yank to the fore of our brains (minds?) and viscera (souls?) those thoughts and emotions which the endless procession of the passage of days buries beneath the debris of information overload. Is it any wonder then that Iconoclasts are drawn to art, given its implied nature? They need not be artists as such, since being an Iconoclast is not what one does but rather how one lives. Iconoclasm should be a way of life, a state of mind, an instinct, as naturally automatic as breathing. A carpenter can be just as much an Iconoclast as a painter! And what is art, anyway? Oh dear! Forgive me! There I go again, off on another philosophical joyride! And I used the "I" word far sooner than I had intended! Oh well, I suppose there's no point in waiting any longer to explain what an Iconoclast is...or at least give you some opinions as to what an Iconoclast can be...

An Iconoclast can be a radical non-conformist, someone who tears apart old norms and conventions, the old icons held sacred by a culture that have worn out their usefulness, and replace these societal tatters with something completely new...a rampaging zealot of reform that shakes apart foundations. Conversely, an Iconoclast can be a nurturing force of change, gradual rather than abrupt, subtle in a quest to undermine the norm little by little until it comes crashing down. She or he can "work within the system", taking bits of the past and present and making a beautiful new quilt of reality (for lack of a better metaphor). Note that an Iconoclast does not necessarily have to hate the past. Some seek to clear away the dross of sensationalism, the numbing effects of popular ("pop") culture drilled into our brains through commercialism, to open up a pure path to the past. Other Iconoclasts do turn their noses up to antiquity and focus on the present or future looking to create something new, whether it be with the leavings of the past involved or not.

However they do it, art, artists, and Iconoclasts should all test our limits as a culture, and eventually push those limits outward in new directions. They show us how our eyes can be different every time we open them after another bout of sleep. Conventional wisdom and beliefs, clichés, common sense, tradition, are potentially stagnating to the society that adheres to them. Once a people make a certain system of universal understanding a habit, independent and creative thought declines! Art has the ability to renew us as individuals, to allow us to be reborn to the stale old world we may inhabit. And if

enough individuals get together, then there are even more possibilities. This may mean experimentation with new horizons as goals, but it need not. Experimentation is a means, not an end. One should give respect to the past, not by following it slavishly but by creating for it a new image, using it in a never-before-thought-of way! As the Modernist poet Ezra Pound was fond of saying..."MAKE IT NEW!" An Iconoclast may acknowledge the past when she is happy and destroy it when she is angry...the possibilities are at her command because she knows that she need not follow the same path as everyone else...and that is most important. Remember, an Iconoclast would not be where he or she is today without the past (note that this statement can cut two ways).

An Iconoclast does subversive slicing in order to heal, a societal surgeon, wielding his or her scalpel of choice: fiction, essays, poetry, or any of the other arts perhaps. Some may consider anarchists with bombs or guns as Iconoclasts, and this kind of deviance may fit at the fundamental fringes of the definition of the word...but one need not kill to cause change (although this might seem to be a way to create immediate effects, this is not always necessarily the case...). Those who seek such violent instant results often spawn more outrage than change, and thus cause greater suspicion towards those crying out for societal reform. In other words, they may only strengthen conformity, making people shrink into the protective shell of conservative complacency. Homo sapiens fear the unknown...and the unknown is where the Iconoclast wants to lead every to...a promised land, so to speak, of infinite human possibilities. But the masses might run to their familiar one-track existences if the Iconoclast uses too heavy a hand. So think before you act.

Eccentric saints, poets, jesters, madmen, Iconoclasts...all are social pariahs with wisdom derided and disdained. They are the lepers of the society. Don't let that discourage you. The true artist or Iconoclast is not concerned with hubris or image; one is an Iconoclast because one feels the need for it. He or she senses something lacking in his or her home, town, state, country, world, universe...whatever! Call it your society or culture or reality...what matters is not the label, but that things need change. An Iconoclast does not write what she thinks everyone wants, she writes what she wants everyone to think...an Iconoclast is a fool to the conventional, and is treated as such. But modern minds have forgotten that the fool has many faces: the heart of paradox, the destroyer who creates is the Iconoclast...avatar of cultural entropy, the destructive chaos that brings rebirth, grinding up society's dead leaves to make fertile pulp to grow something new...yet never forget that he or she is nourished by the decaying matter left by the great thinkers, inventors, and trailblazers of the past. Remember, traditions mean well, but they must be reformed, recycled, recreated from time to time...or else erased, scoured into nothingness and totally replaced.

And now I think I have subjected you, brave reader, to enough of my diatribe on Iconoclasm. Forgive my redundant tendencies, but I find repetition a good way to create a lasting impression on the mind. I could go on and on in an endless tirade when it comes to this subject. After all, like they say in the theater business, practice makes permanent! Don't forget to think for yourselves, huh? It is your world...don't let anyone convince you otherwise.

Irony by griffin faulkner

Tuesday morning, and cruising at 70 miles per hour, the delivery vehicle maneuvered through the lanes of traffic along Interstate 95. This mobile streak of red was returning from a vending machine delivery at the Nude Girl Sex Bar and wore the grin of its driver. Both faces reflected where they had been. "Big-busted blonde bimbos are just our type," thought Liesel as she fumbled with the radio stations in a desperate attempt to find music. While she searched, she played with memories of the women she had watched earlier through the glass windows and through the sounds of coins clinging in change machines. She never dreamt of touching-or even going to such a place without necessity; but she definitely passed a respectful glance to an artistic creation. Granted, she didn't believe any entity or god created such lovelies, "but such superior cell structure is sexy!" she thought in her college snob voice.

Liesel was listening to a commercial for a new game show on Cable and looking in her mirror occasionally at the Volkswagon following her. Weaving through the traffic, the two cars raced towards separate destinations in rhythmic procession, always avoiding the passing lane if possible. Both were respectful of the businessmen in Armani suits who blindly shook spare fingers at their cell phones-perhaps believing a human being might be peering out of one of the phone's digital numbers.

Ben Stein spoke in the background while Liesel felt a sort of partisanship with this similarly conscious driver: "I'm innocent. I'm not a bad guy. I haven't done anything to anyone." As Liesel glanced again into her mirror, she felt an icy chill creep over her. The Volkswagon's bumper came within centimeters of her own as the two vehicles sped down the highway. As the distance between the cars closed further, Liesel attempted, repeatedly, to make the other driver aware of her steadily growing apprehension through "considerate driver telepathy." She had taken a course in first aid and knew how horrible such an accident could be at high speeds. She refused to address other thoughts about the black Jetta's intention.

As her hands gripped the wheel tighter, Liesel gazed into the abyss of Route 95. The black demon edged closer and closer, and finally came so close that it tapped her bumper enough to create a disturbance. Liesel jerked the wheel to the right and took the car into the slow lane, scraping against a silver Datsun. Red streaks of paint shot across random cars on the highway as the Honda's driver lost control of the car, sending it careening through all four lanes of the busy street, across the median, into the opposing traffic. The car finally came to rest after it had jumped over a Dodge Neon and taken out the signs directing northbound traffic to the exit for New Hope. Liesel looked down at her legs and saw mangled appendages, and blood spurting

everywhere. Ben Stein came from the radio "I don't dance." Liesel's hands gripped the wheel slightly tighter as she looked behind her.

The black Jetta was still only inches away from her bumper as they continued towards Philadelphia. Her attempts to make her assailant aware of the impending doom failing, Liesel stretched her arm out the window pointing out the wide open passing lane. Still, the two cars came within hairs of contact. Liesel slowed the car causing the Jetta to make a sharp turn into the passing lane. As the car passed, Liesel saw the most beautiful woman in the passenger seat give her a sideways glance. Both faces lingered for a moment and the small Oriental girl flashed a heartening smile. Liesel's eyes lit, she stepped on the gas and began pursuit of the black Jetta. She noticed the girl's enormous boyfriend in the driver's seat flexing his hairy-behemoth arms at her, but did not mind the idea of kicking his ass. The commercial was still broadcasting over the radio in Ben Stein's monotone: "I do enjoy fierce competition." The black Jetta was still behind her, and as she looked more closely, it had only one inhabitant.

Perplexed about the Jetta's seeming ignorance about her fear, Liesel tapped her brakes. Still the Volkswagon assailed the red Honda's bumper with threats of imminent collision. The traffic grew sparse, and now there were few cars on the road. Liesel decided that she would finally slow down and pull over because she could not seem to make the car understand. As she pulled further to the right, the black car followed her until both finally pulled over. It all began to make sense to Liesel. The car's driver must have noticed some problem with her car-perhaps a flat tire, or a missing tail light. She stepped out of her car and bumped against a huge greasy looking man weighing about two hundred pounds and bearing a maniacal grin behind a pistol. Ben Stein's voice came again like a blind automaton-something about contestants having to beat him at his own game. Liesel's heart pounded with her overactive imagination temporarily suspended once again.

The black car was still behind her, and still inches away from her car. "You stupid shit. I suppose I'll just have to slow down for you then" said Liesel in disgust to her imaginary driving companion. The little red Civic let up and slowed to a snail paced 60 miles per hour, only to aggravate the aggressive black menace enough to pull into the passing lane-barely missing a white Firebird.

The woman in the passing car passed one brightly painted fingernail in front of a leering grimace. As the face of evil's bumper came into view, Ben Stein was finishing his endorsement: "Even I laughed." On the car's bumper was a sticker proclaiming: PRACTICE RANDOM ACTS OF KINDNESS AND SENSELESS BEAUTY.

UGLY by Amy Sciarretto

It is such an ugly, face contorting quality...when others have nothing sweeter to do with their time than purport the actions and words of those who take the initiative and make changes and work their fucking asses off.
Ugly indeed.

BLUE IN GREEN

Breakfast, lunch & coffee

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STEVE-THE HOT DOG MAN

Condemned by the gods to poverty.
Resident Greek scholar at Rutgers
and a trained professional.

THE ICONOCLAST brought to you by Andrea Chrisman, Anthony Simeone, Bruce Kramer and Amy Sciarretto. Layout by Matthew W. Weatherbee. Writers o'rama: Jonathan Faszczuk, Sean Mulroy, Rebecca Duncan, Kristina Lindsay, Bertram Redgrave, Nicole Nader, Tom Wright Jr., Susan Muaddi, Muses to the Writers: John Rothwell, Deborah Cornatzer, Shawn Sullivan, Valencia Jackson and Slappy Stink Head. Special thanks to Harvey Hurricane and a very dead Nietzsche.

Please send all submissions, contributions, Papal Decrees, Ben and Jerry's, Gophered Scuppernon wine or chocolate of any kind (we especially like Godiva dark) to p00h@clam.rutgers.edu (the two O's are zeroes), or The Iconoclast, c/o P.O. Box 2133, Cinnaminson, NJ 08077.

The Iconoclast's
Thought for the week:
 Courtesy of Ashleigh Brilliant
 My opinions may have changed, but not the fact that I am right.

Goodbye English Rose and All That Good Stuff.

By Bruce Kramer

The world was recently shocked by the tragic death of Princess Diana as a result of drunk driving. (Oh yeah, and that other guy who died in the car too. Whatever his name was...). And of course with the death of any major celebrity, we have the sudden mass production of tributes: poems, songs, books, movies, documentaries, commemorative plates, T-shirts, and various other trinkets all dedicated to the deceased. Well, we here at the Iconoclast thought we had to somehow jump on the bandwagon and come up with our own tribute. Having the duty bestowed upon me, I have come up with a way that will honor her and generate money for a positive cause. Oh, we're not going to be like a certain musician and just change two words in a song and dedicate it to her English Roseness in order to line our greedy pockets. I give you:

The Princess Diana Rockin' Royalty World Tour '97
 A few decades ago, we bailed the UK out of WWI and WWII. As a result of that, we gave them thousands of money worth of weapons and supplies. Did they pay us back? No. So we should come out and demand that it be repaid. We'll give them a reasonable time frame to get the money together: say, 24 hours. If they say no, we say we'll just take the Princess' body and call it even. I think that's a fair enough deal considering how much they owe her. What are they going to do about it if they say no? We kicked their arses over 200 years ago and we'll do it again. They can leave her crypt or whatever in England so they can go grieve her death.

But we in America, being the entrepreneurs we are, send her body on a tour of every major American stadium from the Atlantic to the Pacific. People can pay their hard earned money to pay their final respects to the deceased queen. We could even have a mock funeral every night for her. Even better yet, we kidnap Elton John and make him sing that damn Candle In The Wind song every night while we hook her body up to a large car battery and make her dance to it. Maybe even have a raffle where the some lucky person can get to hit the power switch. We put it on pay-per-view television for \$14.95 maybe include a free porn movie right after it so we get increased viewership. Then we take all the money and sink it right into the school systems of where the show is going on. Between ticket sales, beer concessions, and the millions of "Princess Di Died But Still Kicks Ass" T-shirts we would sell, the entire education system could get a turn around. Her royalness was also so concerned with disarming landmines in the world so for the finale, we could throw wooden cutouts of her onto active landmines on stage to teach the kiddies a valuable lesson. Not only can we make some money, but we must look at the educational value here as well.

What you can do is call your local representative and support the Princess Di Tour Bill (I think it was just introduced into Congress) and keep reading the Iconoclast for more brilliant revenue generating ideas.

Big Guy by Anthony Simeone

A body violent to verse
rips down the sides of lips;
"Large hands couldn't possibly tickle
a page with passable poetry!"
Alien size inflates the brain,
gods are lost in the open spaces,
Intelligent cages stunt the flight
and tear off angel wings
(the predatory IQ stalks
the fancy fluff-tailed imagination).
Dead doves clutching poem prayers
are never heard,
Muses wonder why and move on...
I do not want to make you laugh.
To move to enlightened tears would do.
Smiles still killing make the ponder roots stillborn,
caving in skulls through joyful faces,
dins of snickers and jibes cover voices in
communion...
Poking eyes and eardrums of those in the
creativity freakgeek sideshow,
the trendy mundanes hahaha-ing at the
socially uncool deformities that art-dreaming spawns,
cackling at the visage of transcendence to tolerance
that might make them-us-all alright...
Yet a planet capers meanders in forward circles
proud of its jocular folly,
opressing profitless prophets dancing the
serious professional fool's jig,
flowers clutched in the palms of the wise.

Real by Rachel Buchman

I am grey drizzle
mush wet on the back of your neck
Sliding droplet into collar
Like moist wet on a juice drink
I am the empty gym
After hours
Lights dim
Stand you near the rafters
And howl at your weeping
I will echo
Because no one else can hear
I am your false front
I am your cool
I am the "lack thereof"
A hipster beer
Painted blue
I slick slide icy
I bowl with no expression
I vandalize a field of anger
I create tension
You bury your face in me
To avoid virginity for virility
A frowning man won't smile
Cause happiness orgasms like real
I will stunt the third dimension
Caesar haircut on flannel
I am non-filtered cigarettes
And cheap wine from the 7-11
I will not stay after sex
I vanish in my own fog
I am the deep meaning of down to earth
Call me
Raw real

Don't you hate it when....

Don't you hate it when there is someone on the campus throwing about pamphlets claiming all sorts of evil nasty things about your campus, and most of the complaints are for a lack of BEER? Now, of course i recognize the primitive urge towards intoxication and happy go lucky partying and all sorts of lovely things like that; yet i feel that someone really should tuck in the children who sent out the extremely laughable flyer that tried to get the attention of people who could change policy on campus grounds.

The very least these young ruffians could have done is use proper grammar...perhaps not use the fuck insertion clause ad naseum...perhaps sign their names to their work if they were so proud to publish. Here's an idea: put your passions to good use and save a tree from the art department. Better yet, why not make some billboards and protest the frat houses that were closed down because they were hosting parties and underaged children were getting their fill of liquor.



Down the Line by Jacqueline Bloom

A darling pixie
navigating those unblemished shores,
dreaming of love centuries past
racing to purify this world
exuding a seamless beauty
arriving at an opportune time...

idle much too long,
senseless winds push us away...

caressing your cherished memory,
on the horizon...our bitter end?
Or will our ships chart the same path-

lurching toward another time, united as one

A Momentary Type Thang by John Fazczyk

like a splinter
lodged mid
epidermis and
the nail
hurts penultimate
to loves lesion
and seeks to be availed

From the Dens of Bitch & Aloan:

Lifestyles Of Those More Important Than You

By Robin Bitch

Hello again everyone! I'm Robin Bitch! And welcome to my dedication to the famous, the powerful, the people who always wear sensible shoes...CELEBRITIES! Yes, my well-meaning but insignificant middle-class readers, they are the idols of all of the faceless in the world. Fate saw fit to grant them more than the usual fifteen minutes of notoriety! They are the ones who really don't need you to be successful or popular, they just tell you how much the fans mean to them to keep you in awe, to make you feel better about your meaningless and monotonous existence. When a celebrity tells you he or she could not have made it to the top without the fans, nod and smile and thank them for the autograph before walking away, as one would lend such respect to a rich but eccentric uncle that might put you in his will. The famous are famous for a reason, I always say! They are obviously better than the average citizen, and should therefore rightly be elevated above the prosaic mundanities in which the masses must eternally toil. Indeed, the muttering mobs of laboring fools must turn to those more fortunate than they are, and study the wisdom they teach by example in their selfless quests for a better movie deal or another product endorsement contract.

Vain, you say? Ah, but there is ancient and classical precedent to my claims regarding the divine right of celebrities. The civilizations that have come before us have given us wisdom from the bowels of antiquity regarding those of fame. "AVanity of vanities, all is vanity," says the oft-quoted Bible verse, and who are we as mere mortals to argue against the Word of God? Indeed, the mandate of the heavens has graced the shoulders of the famous in many cultures. Look to the capricious ways of the

deities populating the Greek pantheon. Did not they eat, drink and make merry? Did they not do as they pleased, and in doing so gain worshippers despite their frivolity? They even received attention from those who hated them, let alone provided examples of how to live decadently in the proper manner. So it is for the modern celebrity. They are to be our gods! A wondrously diverse mythos of the wicked and the bloated with vice, the supposedly innocent until found corruptible! They are the guiding lights to the rabble, revealing how this life should truly be lived! So I proclaim from the highest deck of my yacht: WORSHIP THE SUPERSTAR! You just might learn something! If you are going to consume valuable air on this planet, you might as well do as the celebrities do! And beware those who would blaspheme against the power of fame, for they are the envious who would slander and libel to dethrone the rightfully rich. An stay weary of zealots who would even KILL for a snapshot, like the maniacal paparazzi... er... paparazze?... uh...panzarotti?...pavaroti?...those people named after an Italian food or fat opera singer! There is even talk of a vile man who has developed some perverted plot concerning the body of the dear sweet late Princess Diana involving car batteries and corpse puppet shows! How vulgar! Gossip has it that he plans to print such an idea in this very publication! Do not read his work, friends, for he is damned! Anywho, TA TA FOR NOW! Remember to say your prayers to Elvis tonight, and may you have never-answered wishes and unattainable dreams! The celebs will do all that for you! And you thought being nailed to a cross was a sacrifice!

Bitch & Moan Continued:

These Stinkin' Celebrity Sonofabitches Stink

or Sermon Upon the Celebrity Outlook on Us Working Class Everyday Stiffs

By Joe Schmo Moan

This guy over here here is rambling on about the "modern mythology" and all that bullshit. Do the everyday working class people of the world wanna hear some crap about the new greek gods or what have you? No! They want to hear these stinking money grubbing frauds exposed for exactly what I said they are. Do they give two shits about you or me or whoever? No. Let's take these damn ballplayers for example. I want to go to a game with some friends, guys who work fifty hours a week to put some food on the table. We go to the stadiums and pay our hard earned money and these guys have the freakin' nerve to not even sign an autograph? They get five million dollars to play a goddamned game. And how about those movie stars? I tell you what, bub, they walk into a resteraunt with a waiting list and pull their "No, you don't understand. I'm Mr. SoandSo so I think you DO have a table for me," shit. I ain't gonna take it anymore. Sure you guys all sit up in yer big houses and hang at your snooty-ass parties with the rest of your kind. Fine. But what ticks me off is when you gotta act like the spacemen looking over us morons here of Earth. You all got "issues". Save the

Rainforests, Save the Tibetans, Save the Wales, Feed the Kurds, Protect the Ozone, Stop Nuclear Testing, Clear the Minefields of Vietnam. What damned country is this anyway? Hey, Mr. Rich-and-Famous, you wanna do something real? Try giving all of that money you have to some schools or AIDS patients in cities. Or better yet, try getting off your ass and GETTING A REAL JOB FOR ONCE. You kids out there want a real rolemodel look at the teachers and police officers of the world not some pompous celebrity asshole who looks down at you like you're some kind of sodomite. And one more thing to all you people crying over that dead princes over there in England. Lemmie ask a question: what country is this? Oh, we're not in England you mean? One would think we were considering how everybody was acting like it was their own damn mother who died. She was just an everyday person that got put on one of these damn pedestals by the media. I'm getting so sick of thinking about these stinking weasels, I can't even right anymore.

wandering nights with MK

march 1997 by andrea chrisman

wandering nights
between quasars and pulsars
you taught me the theory of relativity
in numerical equations-
but i learned all
from the square root of your voice.
black holes and ancient constellations
earthquaked through grey-matter
in the company of star-deep winds rising in me.

do you wonder about me?
walking through arbours
of spirit trees
bertrand russell sang to life,
i wanted to share with you
the world i found
in the pocket of my jeans
at the edge of twilight;
but reverie is lost in formulaic equations
and instead you lurk in the shadows
between einstein and pythagoras
in a world of triangle men
with the darkheart secrecy you keep.

The Meek Have Inherited

by Charles Buckowski

if I suffer at this
typewriter
think how I'd feel
among the lettuce-
pickers of Salinas?

I think of the men
I've known in
factories
with no way to
get out--
choking while living
choking while laughing
at Bob Hope or Lucille
Ball while
2 or 3 children beat
tennis balls against
the walls.

some suicides are never
recorded.



A Letter from the Common man by Kristina Lindsay

All I ask for a want
A want strong and tied to the metaphysical law
Acceptance of the only kind
Real

Baggage from another world
Baggage of a young impure child
Purity wrecked by society
A society this one denies love too

I've lived in this manner for several years
Touch me, I'm human just as you are
I was born the same way as you pathetic blinded fucks
I just have a difference, as you do but not as defined

You don't ask questions
You deny me acceptance
I bleed,
You run. Not from my contagiousness, but fear that you
may break into my black wall

I shall not hurt you, I do not bless pain upon you
You fucking yuppie, I envy you
I envy your naiveness and purity
Appreciate your existence. Not your popularity.

I could shower (never) you ignore our friendship

It doesn't exist

He slashed and raped me
You sat and watched.

This could be you. you fear this.

All I ask for is a purist of love.
Not from you-from one who knows how to.
To not have to sing this forbidden dance.
I stepped one too many times, only to create me.

I don't hate you because you're ignorant
Why must you all hate me because I'm living through
unfortunate circumstances.
Your parents love you, they spoil you
I don't know my parents, we've never met.

You have nice clothes
I do too, but not in your eyes, I had to discuss prices of
my shreds with a panhandler.
I work
You bullshit.

I love,
You fear.
I eat pills to numb my pains, to prevent my fucking disease
from make my decisions
You do it to create a false reality.

Live life you Yuppie-Scum, you have one.



LOGIC to PONDER from The Associated Mess

If you throw a cat out a car window does it become kitty litter? If corn oil comes from corn, where does baby oil come from? If there is no God, who pops up the next Kleenex in the box? How did a fool and his money GET together? If it's tourist season, why can't we shoot them? Why do they sterilize the needles for lethal injections? What do they use to ship styrofoam? Why is there an expiration date on my sour cream container? Why do kamikaze pilots wear helmets? How do you know when it's time to tune your bagpipes? When you choke a smurf, what color does it turn? Do blind Eskimos have seeing-eye sled dogs? Why do they call it a TV set when you only get one? Do radioactive cats have 18 half-lives? What was the best thing before sliced bread? Why isn't phonetic spelled the way it sounds? Why are there flotation

devices under plane seats instead of parachutes? Have you ever imagined a world with no hypothetical situations? How does the guy who drives the snowplow get to work in the mornings? If a cow laughed, would milk come out her nose? If you're in a vehicle going the speed of light, what happens when you turn on the headlights? You know how most packages say "Open here?" What is the protocol if the package says, "Open somewhere else?" Why do they put Braille dots on the keypad of the drive-up ATM? You know that little indestructible black box that is used on planes, why can't they make the whole plane out of the same substance? Why is it that when you're driving and looking for an address, you turn down the volume on the radio?

MIR Scientists Study Effects of Weightlessness on Mortal Terror

From The Associated Mess

KOROLYOV, RUSSIA--U.S. and Russian scientists are increasingly excited about the MIR space station project, which promises to reveal more than has ever been known about the scientific relationship between weightlessness and mortal terror. "By stranding our scientists on a dilapidated space station with faulty wiring, loose hardware, and malfunctioning air systems," NASA head Daniel Goldin said, "we have created extremely favorable conditions for learning about spaceborne panic."

The two Russians and one American on board the station are reportedly terrified beyond lucidity.

Among the groundbreaking experiments conducted on board Mir: a June 25 collision with a cargo craft that depressurized the Spektr module; last week's emergency power shortage, caused by a disconnected cable; and the periodic release of "dry ice" steam that simulates a shipboard fire. All have been deemed a huge success by agency heads.

"They are in a constant state of what aerospace scientists term

'mind-shattering terror,' frightened for their very lives," Russian mission director Vladimir Solovyov said. "And we have not even used the hull-mounted Alien puppet that taps on the window yet."

"We have also taken huge leaps in our understanding of the patterns created when one wets his pants in the weightlessness of space," Solovyov said.

Taking a break from his busy schedule, astronaut Michael Foale told ABC News reporters: "Where is Mommy?"

"Please tell me the access code to the Soyuz capsule," Russian cosmonaut Aleksandr Lazutkin said. "I would like to return to the chaotic government and widespread hunger of my homeland."

Scientists expect to gain even more useful data during an experiment at 3 a.m. tomorrow. As the astronauts sleep, whirling red siren lights will flood the cabin while an ear-splitting

klaxon alarm jolts them awake. Detailed scientific data will then be collected on such variables as open weeping, and hair loss.



THE ICONOCLAST
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